

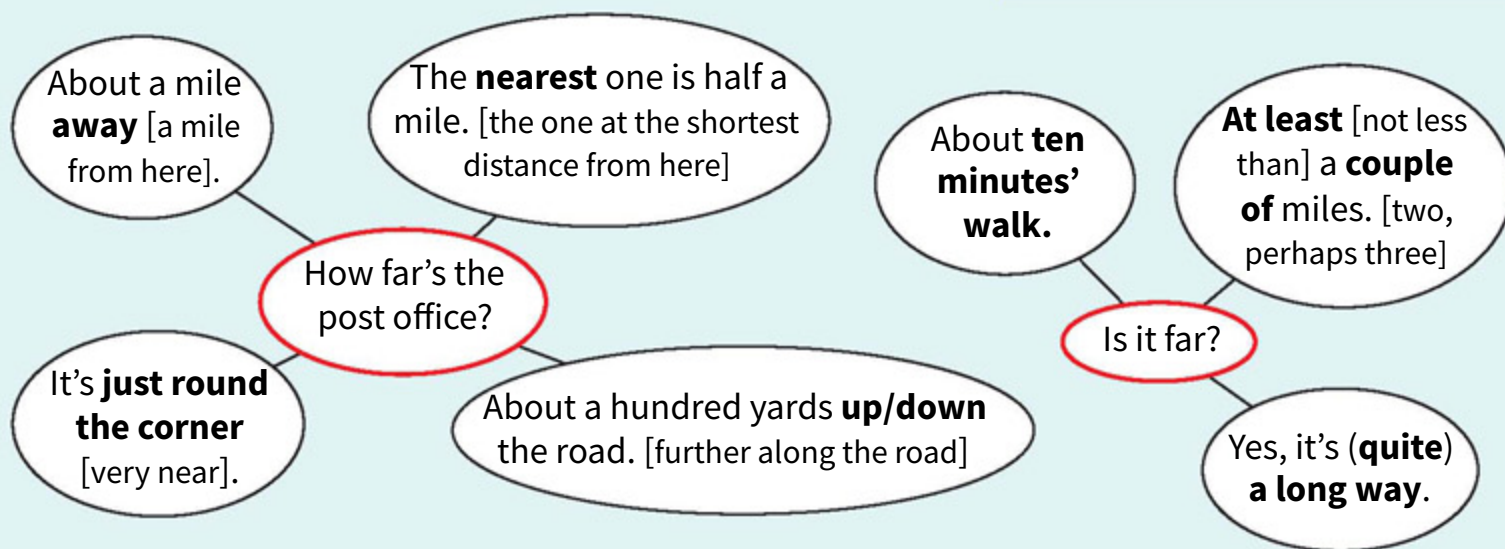
## A

**Distance: how far ...**

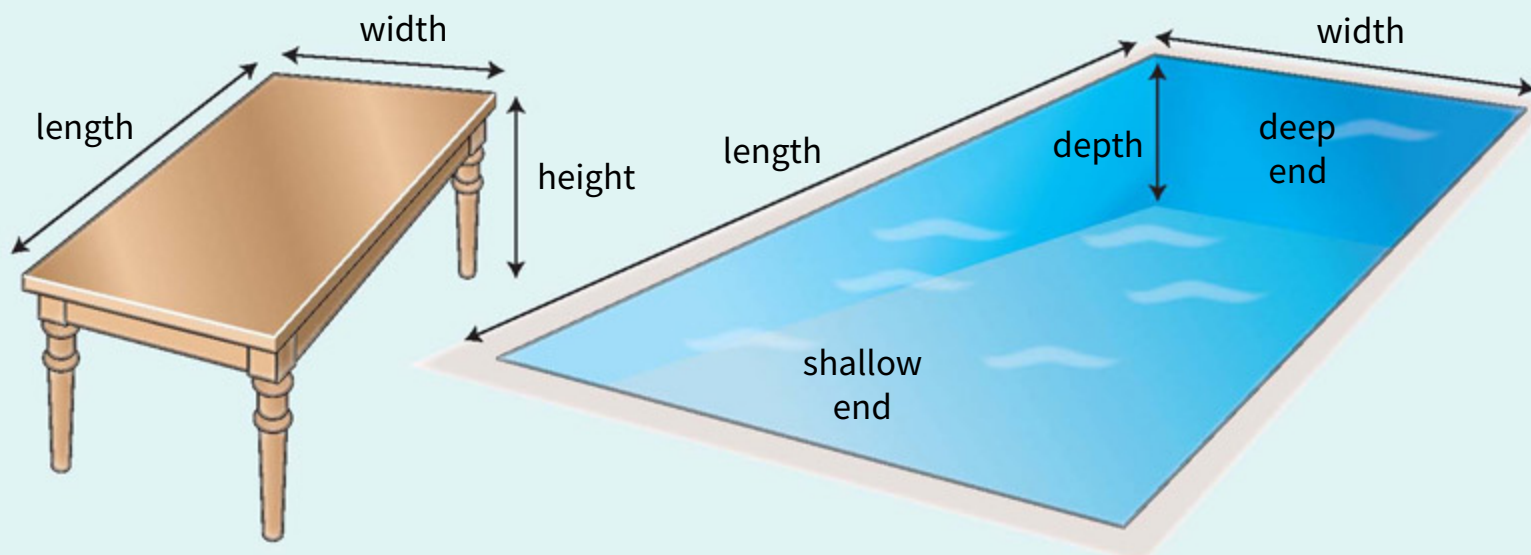
British people buy most things in metres, centimetres and millimetres, but they still often talk about distance using the old system of **miles** [1 mile = about 1.6 kilometres], **yards** [1 yard = almost 1 metre], **feet** [1 foot = 30 centimetres], and **inches** [1 inch = 2.5 centimetres].

## Common mistakes

It's ten minutes' walk from here. (NOT ten minutes' walking.)  
It's a long way. (NOT It's far.) But we can say 'No, it isn't far.'



## B

**Dimensions: how long or wide ...**

## Common mistakes

Mason is quite **tall** (NOT quite high). It's a **tall** tree/building (NOT a high tree/building). It's a **high** mountain (NOT a tall mountain).

We can ask about the dimensions like this:

What's the **length** of the garage? OR How **long** is the garage?

What's the **width** of the path? OR How **wide** is the path?

What's the **height** of the wall? OR How **high** is the wall?

What's the **depth** of the pool? OR How **deep** is the pool?

It's five metres (**long**).

It's a metre (**wide**).

It's two metres (**high**).

It's three metres (**deep**).

## C

**Size: how big or small ...**

We use a range of adjectives to describe the size of something.

It was a very **thick** book – over 500 pages. (*opp* a **thin** book)

Their living room is **huge** [very big; *syn enormous*; *opp* a **tiny** room].

We caught a **giant** crab. [very large or bigger than other similar things]

It was a very **narrow** road for a bus. (*opp* a **wide** road)

# Exercises

## 62.1 Disagree with the speaker in each dialogue.

- 1 A: It's only a thin book, isn't it?  
B: No, *it's quite thick.*
- 2 A: The water's deep in the middle, isn't it?  
B: No, \_\_\_\_\_
- 3 A: Is the road very wide at that point?  
B: No, \_\_\_\_\_
- 4 A: James is quite short, isn't he?  
B: No, \_\_\_\_\_
- 5 A: They only live in a small place, don't they?  
B: No, \_\_\_\_\_
- 6 A: Is it a really huge pool?  
B: No, \_\_\_\_\_

## 62.2 Complete the questions (in two ways) about the lake, the mountain, the woman and the football pitch.



- |                                      |                           |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 How <i>deep</i> _____ is the lake? | 5 How _____ is she?       |
| 2 What's _____ the lake?             | 6 What's her _____?       |
| 3 How _____ is the mountain?         | 7 How _____ is the pitch? |
| 4 What's _____ the mountain?         | 8 What's _____ the pitch? |

## 62.3 Over to you

Think about the building you are in now, and answer the questions using expressions from the opposite page.

- 1 How far is it to the nearest shop? \_\_\_\_\_
- 2 How far is it to a bank? \_\_\_\_\_
- 3 Is it very far to the nearest bus stop? \_\_\_\_\_
- 4 Is it very far to a post office? \_\_\_\_\_
- 5 Is it a long way to the nearest swimming pool? \_\_\_\_\_
- 6 Is it a long way to the next big town? \_\_\_\_\_
- 7 How far is the nearest train station? \_\_\_\_\_
- 8 Is it far to the centre of town? \_\_\_\_\_